



INTERNATIONAL SOCIETY
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PULSE-R²⁴

THE DAILY CORPORATE INTELLIGENCE BULLETIN



PULSE- R²⁴—Where the nation's security pulse meets insight. Delivers forward-looking updates on emerging risks and developments impacting business continuity and organizational resilience in India.

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Ranked by incident impact timeline
across Tier-1 cities

Leadership Analysis

Middle East Conflict: A Corporate Risk Analysis for India

The ongoing conflict between Israel (US-backed) and Iran has developed into a complex economic and security challenge for India, affecting energy supplies, trade routes, corporate cost structures, and workforce stability. Even though India has short-term safeguards in place, a prolonged escalation is likely to increase financial pressure, disrupt operations, and heighten security risks for businesses.

The escalation has triggered a broader geopolitical shock with global implications. Disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz, which transports nearly 20% of global oil and a major share of India's imports have driven fuel price increases. India's heavy reliance on this corridor for crude oil, LNG, and LPG has begun to strain both households and commercial operations, with sectors such as hospitality already facing limitations. Additionally, supply chain disruptions are affecting raw material availability and driving up operational costs across industries.

Although Iran has allowed selective movement of Indian vessels, shipping remains constrained due to security concerns, reduced traffic, and higher insurance and freight costs, keeping global oil prices volatile. Domestically, prices have stayed relatively stable due to government intervention, including excise duty cuts. However, sustained global increases may eventually raise domestic costs. India's Oil Ministry stated on 26 March that crude supplies are secured for the next 60 days and advised against panic buying.



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Corporate Impact Assessment

- **Economic and Cost Pressures (High Impact; High Probability):** Industries that rely heavily on petroleum products remain structurally exposed, particularly transport and trade-related sectors where fuel costs directly influence operations. Rising energy costs are increasing overall operating expenses, putting pressure on margins and forcing companies to either absorb the costs or pass them on to consumers, which carry business risks.
- **Workforce and Operational Continuity (Moderate Impact; High Probability):** Fuel shortages are likely to disrupt daily corporate operations, particularly employee mobility, business travel, and on-ground activities. Travel costs, including routine employee transportation and air travel, are expected to rise, resulting in reduced trip frequency, route prioritization, and tighter travel planning. Notably, airfares have already risen as the government increased aviation fuel prices to offset the cost of keeping domestic household fuel rates stable.
- **Currency and Financial Market Volatility (Moderate Impact; High Probability):** Businesses that trade internationally may face higher import costs and more expensive insurance to protect against currency changes. These fluctuations can also create unpredictable risks for the company's overall financial health and transition into elevated security risks across corporate operations.

Recommended Actions for Corporates

1. Activate and regularly review business continuity plans, including readiness for Work From Home (WFH).
2. Strengthen employee safety protocols and secure transport arrangements.
3. Diversify sourcing to reduce reliance on single regions for raw materials.
4. Plan for energy cost fluctuations through robust hedging strategies.
5. Enhance cybersecurity monitoring and incident response mechanisms.
6. Conduct scenario-based planning for short- and medium-term risks.

Security Impact

- **Travel Risks (High Impact; High Probability):** Travel risk remains elevated across the Middle East, with exposure to sudden airspace restrictions, route diversions, and evolving regulatory controls. Uncertainty around key transit hubs like Dubai and Doha could lead to longer travel times, missed connections, and reduced itinerary reliability. This increases the risk of stranded travelers and limited alternative routes, requiring stronger travel planning, approvals, and real-time monitoring.
- **Regional Employee Risks (High Impact; High Probability):** For Indian companies with offices in the Middle East, a prolonged conflict increases employee safety risks. A worsening situation may trigger a mass return of staff to India, causing operational gaps. Companies must be prepared for evacuations, remote work shifts, and potential risks to local bank accounts or assets during emergencies.
- **Physical Security Risks (High Impact; Moderate Probability):** Protests or civil unrest may cause operational disruptions, infrastructure damage, and temporary shutdowns, especially in key business areas. Duty-of-care obligations increase, requiring enhanced transport security, tracking systems, and emergency response measures, with potential legal and reputational consequences.
- **Cybersecurity Threats (High Impact; Moderate Probability):** There is an increased risk of cyber threats during geopolitical tensions, resulting in financial losses, regulatory penalties, operational downtime, and reputational damage, especially critical for the BFSI, IT, and e-commerce sectors.
- **Targeted Risks (High Impact; Moderate Probability):** Major cities and economic hubs remain potential targets for attacks, possibly focusing on US-based organizations, as seen in recent weeks. This could result in severe business disruption, employee risk, and long-term financial impact.

Conclusion

The IMF indicates that the situation remains highly volatile, with the overall impact of the conflict depending on its duration, geographic spread, and the extent of disruption to infrastructure and supply chains. Continued disruptions to energy flows and maritime routes are expected in the near term, likely keeping oil prices elevated and trigger ripple effects across dependent industries.

Overall, the situation is evolving from a short-term disruption into a prolonged risk environment, requiring companies to prioritize resilience, flexibility, and proactive risk management. Hence, Corporates should prepare for sustained disruption rather than quick normalization.

Today's Key Bulletins

Air India Suspends Delhi–Tel Aviv Flights Till May 31

Air India has suspended its Delhi–Tel Aviv flights till May 31 due to the ongoing West Asia conflict and security risks. Most international airlines have also halted services on this route, leaving limited operations under restrictions. This disruption is affecting over 40,000 Indians in Israel, who now have to travel via alternate routes through Jordan or Egypt. The Indian embassy is providing assistance and support during the situation. The situation highlights ongoing travel disruptions and operational uncertainty, with continued impact on international movement and connectivity.

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Thunderstorm Activity Likely Across Bengal Till April 9

Kolkata

The IMD has forecast thunderstorms, gusty winds, and intermittent rainfall across several West Bengal districts till April 9, with Kolkata likely to experience evening showers and localized weather disturbances. The continued spell of unstable weather may lead to periodic disruptions in urban movement, reduced visibility, and localized waterlogging, requiring flexible scheduling, buffer travel time, and caution in outdoor and transit operations across the region.

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Hyderabad Elevated Corridors: Major Boost to Traffic Relief

Hyderabad

Hyderabad's elevated corridor project has received a major boost with ₹5,106 crore funding support from the New Development Bank to improve city traffic flow. The project will build two key elevated corridors from Paradise Junction towards Shamirpet and NH-44, targeting major congestion points. These corridors will help reduce traffic congestion, improve travel time, and separate long-distance and local traffic for smoother movement. The project is expected to enhance connectivity, improve road safety, and support the city's growing transport needs.

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Security Intensified in Chennai Ahead of Political Visits

Chennai

Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Rahul Gandhi are scheduled to arrive in Chennai on April 6, with movements via the airport and onward travel, prompting heightened security and controlled access at key transit points as election activity gains momentum. The increased security presence and coordinated movements are likely to impact traffic flow and access along key routes, requiring time buffers, route planning, and close monitoring of advisories to minimise disruptions.

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India-Bangladesh Ties Thaw: Foreign Minister's April 8 Visit Eyes Visa Revival and Bilateral Reset

India-Bangladesh relations are warming as Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman visits India on April 8 to meet Jaishankar, seeking revival of suspended tourist visas, water-sharing accord, and broader bilateral trade and mobility cooperation. Travelers and businesses should monitor visa policy updates closely. Corporates operating in the India-Bangladesh corridor must prepare for potential resumption of cross-border movement, reviving trade, medical tourism, and supply chain operations significantly.

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India Resumes Iran Oil Imports; Govt Denies Payment Issue Claims

India has imported crude oil from Iran for the first time since 2019 amid global supply disruptions caused by the West Asia conflict. The Petroleum Ministry confirmed that supplies are secure and there are no payment issues in these transactions. The government also dismissed reports claiming an Iran-bound cargo was diverted to China due to payment problems, calling them factually incorrect and reaffirming stable energy supply. This move helps strengthen India's energy security and diversify supply sources during ongoing geopolitical uncertainty.

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Dust Menace Chokes Sector 79 Manesar

NCR

Residents of Sector 79, Manesar, allege severe dust pollution from RMC plants and construction, affecting 8,000 people. Despite repeated complaints, enforcement remains weak. Authorities promise inspections and action against violators. Residents and commuters should wear masks near Sector 79, Manesar. Businesses must ensure dust compliance, cover material transport, and anticipate regulatory penalties amid tightening pollution inspections affecting construction and corporate operations nearby.

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